

XI. IR'AM-AŠŠUR (189-205)

Ir'am-Aššur was the son of Id(d)i-bāni¹ and married to Šalimma, a daughter of Elamma, as shown by Kt 93/k 513:17, "Šalimma, daughter of Elamma" (courtesy C. Michel). A long letter, *206, sent by her sister Ummī-lšhara from Assur to Šalimma in Kanesh, in which she tries to mediate between her and her husband Ir'am-Aššur, who lived in Assur and whom she refused to join, is edited in Ch. XII, devoted to Šalimma.

Ir'am-Aššur's name is usually spelled *Ir-ma-Aššur*, with contraction, but occasionally *Ir-am-Aššur* (*226:1 // B:18) and he even occurs as *Na-ra-am-Aššur*, son of Id(d)i-bāni (in *233:3). He owned the seal CS 1148, which carries an inscription mentioning its previous owner, a man from Ebla (see the drawing in Teissier 1994, 233 no. 527), used three times on texts from the archive. This chapter presents the texts of or concerning him that ended up in Elamma's archive, no doubt in consequence of his marriage. But he is also known from his own archive, found in the first house excavated in 1994, texts numbered Kt 94/k 117-184, provisional transcriptions of which were kindly made available to me by Cécile Michel.²

Ir'am-Aššur was a trader active in Anatolia and who traveled between Kanesh and Assur, where he also stayed for some time. He occurs dozens of times in texts from different archives,³ with dates ranging from eponymy year REL 92 (*195) to year 111 (Kt 94/k 143). He apparently had some form of cooperation with Elamma's sons, in particular after Elamma's death. They considered him their senior (calling him "father and boss") and in their trading operations also handled merchandise belonging to him. That he was somewhat older is confirmed by the appearance of his son, named after his grandfather, as witness for him in the undated *192:15-16. From his own archive we have a record relating to the division between him and his brother Aššur-rabi of the inheritance of their father, witnessed by four men (Kt 94/k 157, courtesy of C. Michel). It states "Ir'am-Aššur and Aššur-rabi, sons of Id(d)i-bāni, have sworn an oath by the City and they have been entitled⁴, so that they will not raise claims against each other for anything, whatsoever, belonging to their paternal estate. (11) What their father's sister and their own sister will leave behind (*warkutum*) will belong to the two of them" (*ša*

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This name is usually spelled NI-DÍ-*ba-ni*, but a rare spelling with initial I-, in *226:2, *Ir-am-A-šur* / DUMU *I-dí-ba-ni*, shows that NI- is to be read Ì-, but I do not know what the name means. Ir'am-Aššur's son was named after this grandfather, see *192:15-16.

² It contains a dozen debt-notes in which he is creditor, letters to him, records of private summonses and litigation in which he is one of the parties, a contract of the marriage of his daughter Suhkana, a slave-sale, and an agreement with his brother Aššur-rabi on the division of assets of their "paternal house". His above-mentioned seal CS 1148 is impressed on Kt 94/k 179, which he seals as a debtor who owes 10 minas of silver to Iliya (from eponymy year REL 113).

³ E.g. in AKT 1, 40B:1; 2, 39:2; 4, 26:47-60; 6-b, 441:27, 502:1-4; BIN 6, 31:2; 63:16'; 73:2; 96:17; CTMMA 78c:1; CCT 3, 27a:1; 5, 26d:14; *EL* 93:1; 235:9.27.30 (correct in both texts Abum-Aššur into *Ir-ma-Aššur*); KTBI. 5:16; Prag I, 535:23; 653:6; 750:2; *RA* 58 no. 22:18. 24; TC 3, 67-69; 127:4; 155:13; 209:22; 210:11; VS 26, 2:2; 3:5; Kt c/k 528:2; 671:9; etc.

⁴ L. 6, *šalluṭū*, the stative of the D-stem, which must mean that they have acquired, have full disposal of what is their share.

kilišunuma). Here I focus on what texts from Elamma's archive tell us; his business has to be reconstructed when his archive is published.

A. Ir'am-Aššur and Ennam-Aššur (189-194)

The next six texts document business relations between Ennam-Aššur, the eldest son of Elamma (henceforth E.) and his clearly older brother-in-law Ir'am-Aššur (henceforth I.), whom he calls "my father, my boss". The first three are letters by E. to I., the next two are contracts by which amounts of silver of E. are entrusted (*paqādum*) for transport to Assur by I. The last text is a letter sent to I. by his representatives dealing with textiles handled by E.

189. Kt 91/k 290 (1-147-91)

<i>a-na Ir-ma-A-šur qí-bí-m[a um-ma]</i> <i>En-um-A-šur-ma i-nu-[mì i-na]</i> <i>Hu-ra-ma na-áš-pè-er-tá[m]</i> <i>a-dí TÚG.HI.A tù-lá-pì-ta-[ni]</i> 5 <i>e-lá 2¼ GÍN KÙ.B. ša [Ø]</i> <i>ta-dí-na-ni um-ma a-na-ku-[ma]</i> <i>gám-ra-am ša ha-ra-nim a-qá-[tí-a]</i> <i>dí-na-am um-ma a-ta-ma a-°dí</i> TÚG.HI.A <i>ta-ša-lá-ha-ni ù a-na-ku</i> 10 <i>a-lá-ak-ma iš-tù Ha-hi-im</i> 1	Say to Ir'am-Aššur, thus Ennam-Aššur: "When in Hurama you wrote for me a document concerning the textiles, apart from the 2¼ shekels of silver that you had given me, I told you: 'Give me cash the travel expenses', but you answered me: 'Only when you salvage the textiles I will go and send you from Hahhum ½,
½ <ma>-na 1 ma-na ù 2 ma-na a-gám-ri-kà for your expenses'.	or 2 minas (of silver)
<i>ú-šé-ba-lá-kum ù a-dí ma-lá ù ší-/ni-šu</i> <i>a-na Ha-hi-im áš-pu-ra-ku-ma a-ta</i> <i>mì-ma lá tù-uš-té-bi-lam i-nu-mì</i> 15 <i>ta-tal-ku : lá tí-dí-e ki-ma ha-ra-na-tum</i> <i>sà-hu-a-ni ù É.GAL-lu da-nu-ni</i> <i>a-dí a-wa-tum iz-ku-a-ni ITU.8. KAM</i> <i>i-na li-bi ma-tim as-hu-ur</i> TÚG.HI-tù <i>i-na a-lá-ni a-šar ib-ší-ú-ni</i> 20 <i>a-lik-ma TÚG.HI.A ú-šé-ší-a-ma a-na-ah-ma</i> and with	Then I wrote a few times to you in Hahhum, but you did not send me anything. Did you not know that when you had left the roads were in turmoil and the palaces were headstrong? Until the matter was cleared I had to stay 8 months in the interior. I went to where the textiles were, in the villages, and I got the textiles out
TÚG.HI.A <i>a-šé-er ša-zu-za-tí-kà a-na</i> <i>Wa-ah-šu-ša-na °ú-šé-ri-ib-ma</i> 3 TÚG.HI.A <i>a-gám-ri-im i-gí-im-ru</i> l.e. TÚG.HI.A <i>sà-sà-am lá-áp-tù-ma</i> 25 <i>ša-am-ru-šú nu-uk-ta-na-lá-ma</i> them rev. <i>ší-mu-um lá i-ba-ší Pì-lá-ah-lštar</i> <i>a-ma-kam lá e-ta-wu-ku-um ki-ma</i> moth <i>sà-sú-um uš-ta-am-ri-šú-šu-nu</i> <i>ù ší-ma-am ba-at-qám ú-kà-i-lu-ni</i>	great effort I brought the textiles into Wahšušana to your representatives. Three textiles were spent for expenses. The textiles are affected by moth and in bad condition. We repeatedly offered for sale, but there were no buyers. Did Pilah-lštar not tell you there that the has ruined them and that one offers a bad price for them?

30	10 TÚG.HI.A <i>a-na 2½ ma-na</i> KÙ.B. 2½ [<i>ta-/ad-nu</i>	Ten textiles have now been sold for [minas of
silver.		
	KÙ.B. <i>ša ki-ma ku-a-tí ik-nu-ku-nim-ma</i> <i>a-na-kam i-ba-ší ki-ma i-na Hu-ra-ma</i> me in <i>tù-na-hi-dí-ni um-ma a-ta-ma šu-ma</i> <i>a-ha-at-kà a-na A-lim^{ki} ta-lá-kam</i> KÙ.B.	Your representatives sealed the silver and it is here. While you instructed Hurama as follows: 'If your sister goes to the City, give the silver, the price
the		
35	<i>ší-im</i> TÚG.HI.A <i>dí-ší-ma</i> ° <i>lu₂ ta-li-kam</i> come <i>a-na-kam ki-ma ku-šú da-nu-ni-ma</i> here [<i>lá na-tù-ma</i>	textiles yielded, to her and let her here'. But since a severe cold reigns [it is not feasible for
her		
	<i>lá ta-lá-kà-ni a-dí ki-am</i> KÙ.B. <i>lá</i> [<i>ú-šar-ší-im</i>	to go and therefore I did not yield the [silver to
her.		
	<i>a-ta a-ma-kam ma-lá-kà 3 ma-na</i> LÁ [3 GÍN	It is up to you there what to do. I sent [you 2 minas 57
shekels		
	KÙ.B. <i>iš-tí Šu-Sú-en₆ iš-tù Ha-tim</i> 40 <i>ú-<šé>-bi-lá-ku-ma um-ma a-na-ku-ma</i> [<i>a-bi šu-ut</i> <i>i-lá-ak-ma iš-tù A-lim^{ki}</i> AN.NA <i>ú-šé-lá-°ma₂</i>	of silver with Šu-Suen from Hattum thinking: 'He is my father, he will go and bring tin up for me from the City
so		
	KÙ.B. 1 GÍN <i>e-li-a-ma</i> ù KÙ.B. <i>a-DAM.</i> also [[GÀR-ri-a]	that I obtain at least some silver and [can pay silver to my creditor and
send		
	<i>a-š[a-qa]l-ma a-na ša tup-pi-a ú-šé-b[a-a]</i> tablet'. <i>a-ta um-ma a-ta-ma</i> KÙ.B. <i>a-ha-[at-kà]</i> 45 <i>ta-°ah₂-ša-ah-ma a-na ša tup-p[i-kà]</i> [<i>a-tí-dí-ší-im</i>	(what I owe) on the basis of my tablet'. But you, you said: 'Your sister needed silver and I have given it to her on the [basis of your
tablet'.		
	<i>ur-ki-tám i-°ba₂-áb ha-ra-ni-kà</i> [<i>um-ma</i> on [<i>a-ta-ma</i>	Later, when you were about to set out [a journey, you said: 'Give
me		
	KÙ.B. 1 GÍN <i>i-šu qá-tí-kà dí-na-[ma</i> AN.NA 10 <i>ma-na lá-áš-a-ma-ku-ma</i> KÙ.B. so [<i>li-li-a-ku-ma li-ba-am</i>	every single shekel of silver you have then I will buy for you tin, 10 minas, [that you can obtain silver and
gather		
	<i>ri-ší a-ta ki-ma li-bi₄-[m ta-da-nim]</i> me, courage'. But instead of encouraging	

50	1 <i>ma-na</i> 14 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ni-[is-ha-sú DIRI</i> (for) the 1 mina 14 shekels of silver - its	
		[excise added, its transport fee
	paid -	
u.e.	<i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu a-ha-m[a ½ ma-na</i> [KÙ.B.] and in addition ½ mina of silver, temple	
	<i>ik-ri-bu ša A-šur ni-is-h[a-sú DIRI</i> funds of Aššur - its excise added, its	
	[< <i>ša-du-a-sú</i> >	[transport fee paid – that I gave
	you	
	<i>°ša₂-bu IGI A-zu-ta-a ù l-d[í-ba-ni]</i> in the presence of Azutaya and	
	Idī-bāni	
le.e.	<i>a-na ší-a-ma-tim a-dí-na-kum a-ta a-dí</i> to make purchases with, until this very	
	[<i>u₄-mì-im a-nim °AN.NA₂ / ší-im</i> [day you have not sent me the tin	
	bought	
	[KÙ.B.- <i>pì-a lá tù-uš-té-bi₄-la-am</i> [with my	
	silver!	
col. I	<i>um-ma a-na-ku-ma a-bi a-ta</i> I had said: ‘You are my father, my	
	boss,	
56	<i>be-lí a-ta AN.NA. 10 ma-na</i> purchase for me for tin,	
	<i>ša-ma-ma šé-bi₄-lam</i> 10 minas, and send it me’.	
col. II	<i>a-bi₄ a-ta be-lí a-ta ší-im KÙ.B.</i> Please, my father, my boss, send	
	what	
	<i>ša a-dí-na-ku-ni AN.NA-šu šé-bi₄-lam</i> was bought with the silver I gave you,	
	its	
60	<i>e-en₆ A-šur <ša-mì-ra-n></i> tin. Enable me to face Aššur!”	

Notes

3-4. The *našpertum* could be a document proving that I. was the owner (*tamkārum*) of the textiles, which E. might need en route, or a written acknowledgment that E. was entitled to get paid for his expenses.

5. Earlier I had restored *ša-[ni-tám la] taddinanni*, a reading taken over in *Geography* footnote 438, but it is impossible, since it does not explain the subjunctive of the verbal form.

31. This sale is also mentioned in *194:4-20, and in *190:32, where the yield is said to be 3½ minas. The ventive ending of *kanākum* may indicate that it means “to send here under seal”.

42. Note the combination verb + *ma* followed by *ù* and a following verb.

43, 45. My translation tries to render what *ana ša tuppi* + possessive suffix implies.

47-49. See for *išû qātim* the note to *180:16; *libbam rašā’um* is restored after *190:19-20; see for this rare combination, not registered in *CAD L* s.v. *libbu*, the occurrence in UET 6, 414:29 (*CAD R*, 198, 3, a).

56. The left edge (8.2 cm long) starts with one very long line (55), indented at the end, after which the scribe continues in two columns.

62. Final verb supplied on the basis of *190:45-46.

190. Kt 91/k 366 (1-218-91)

a-na Ir-ma-A-šur ù °UTU-ba-ni

To Ir'am-Aššur and Šamaš-bāni,

	<i>a-na Ir-ma-A-šur qí-bi-ma</i>	and in particular to Ir'am-Aššur,
	<i>um-ma En-nam-A-šur-ma</i>	say as follows, thus Ennam-Aššur:
	<i>3 ma-na LÁ 3 GÍN KÙ.B. i-pá-ni-tim</i>	"Previously I sent you 2 minas
5	<i>iš-tù Ha-tim iš-tí Šu-Sú-en₆</i>	57 shekels of silver from Hattum
	<i>ú-šé-bi-lá-ku-ma um-ma a-na-ku-ma</i>	with Šu-Suen and I thought:
	<i>a-bi šu-ut i-lá-ak-ma iš-tù</i>	'He is my father, he will go and send
	<i>a-lim^{ki} AN.NA 10 ma-na ú-šé-ba-lá-ma</i>	me from the City at least 10 minas of tin
	<i>li-ba-am i-da-nam ù KÙ.B.</i>	and thereby encourage me and when
some		
10	<i>1 GÍN e-li-a-ma KÙ.B. a-na</i>	silver becomes available for me I will
	<i>DAM.GÀR-ri-a a-na ša ṭup-pi-a</i>	be able to send silver to my creditor
	<i>ú-šé-ba-al a-ta um-ma a-ta-ma</i>	on the basis of my tablet'. But you said:
	<i>KÙ.B. a-ha-at-kà ta-ah-ša-ah-ma</i>	'Your sister needed the silver, so I gave
it		
	<i>a-na ša ṭup-pi-kà a-tí-dí-ší-im</i>	to her on the basis of your tablet'.
15	<i>ur-ki-tam_x(TIM) i-ba-áb ha-ra-<ni>-kà</i>	Later, when you were about to set out on
	<i>um-ma a-ta-ma KÙ.B. 1 GÍN</i>	a journey, you said: 'Give me every
single		
	<i>i-šu qá-tí-kà dí-na-ma AN.NA</i>	shekel of silver you have available then I
	<i>10 ma-na lá-áš-a-ma lu-šé-bi₄-lá-ku-ma</i>	will buy for you and send you tin,
10		
l.e.	<i>KÙ.B. li-li-a-ku-ma li-ba-/am</i>	minas, so that you can obtain silver and
20	<i>ri-š[í] um-ma a-ta-ma</i>	gather courage!' You also said: 'You
must		
	<i>ù [a-n]a TÚG.HI-tí-a a-na-ah-ma</i>	also exert yourself for my textiles and
rev.	<i>a-šar ša-la₁-hi-im šu-lu-ùh-šu-/nu</i>	salvage them wherever possible.
	<i>TÚG.HI-tù lá i-ha-li-qú °i₂-nu-mi</i>	The textiles must not get lost!'. When
	<i>ta-tal-ku lá tí-dí-e ki-ma</i>	you left, did you not know that the roads
25	<i>ha-ra-na-tum ù É.GAL-lu</i>	and the palaces were causing
difficulties?		
	<i>da-nu-ni a-dí TÚG.HI.A áš-lu-hu ITU.7./</i>	Until I had salvaged the textiles I stayed
	<i>i-na li-bi ma-tim as-hu-ur [KAM</i>	seven months in the interior. Three
textiles		
	<i>3 TÚG.HI.A a-gám-ri-im ša ha-ra-nim</i>	were spent for the expenses of the trip
	<i>i-gi₅-im-ru-ma TÚG.HI.A ku-nu-ki ša</i>	but I managed to ship the textiles under
	<i>[Ku-lu-ma-a</i>	
30	<i>a-šé-er ša-zu-za-tí-kà ú-<šé>-li-ma</i>	Kulumaya's seals to your
representatives.		
	<i>TÚG.HI.A sà-sà-am ša-am-ru-šú-ma</i>	The textiles are badly affected by moth
	<i>a-na 3½ ma-na KÙ.B. ta-ad-nu</i>	and have been sold for (only) 3½ minas
	<i>KÙ.B. i-ku-<nu>-uk ša-zu-uz-tí-kà</i>	silver; the silver, under the seals of your
	<i>kà-ni-/ik-ma</i>	[representative, is
available.		
	<i>i-ba-ší a-bi₄ a-ta be-lí a-ta</i>	Please, my father, my boss, to whom
35	<i>e-lá-kà a-ma-nim a-da-gal KÙ.B.</i>	else but you can I look (for help)? I
collec-		
	<i>1 GÍN i-šu qá-tí-a ú-pá-he-er-ma</i>	ted every single shekel I had available
and		

	[1 <i>ma-na</i> / 14 GÍN	[1 mina 14 shekels of
silver,		
	<i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i>	its excise added, its transport fee paid,
	<i>a-ha-ma</i> ½ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ik-ri-bu ša A-šur</i>	and separately ½ mina of silver,
temple		
39	<i>ku-nu-ki-a</i> IGI <i>A-zu-ta-a</i> IGI <i>l̄-dī-ba-ni</i>	funds of Aššur, I gave you in the
presence		
u.e.	<i>i-na Hu-ra-ma a-na ší-a-ma-tim</i>	of Azutāya and of Idī-bāni in Hurama
	IGI <i>A-zu-ta-a</i> IGI <i>l̄-dī-ba-ni a-dī-na-kum</i>	for making purchases << in the
presence of		
	<i>um-ma a-na-ku-ma a-bi₄ a-ta be-lí a-ta</i>	Azutāya and of Idī-bāni >> and I said:
	AN.NA 10 <i>ma-na</i>	'Please my father, my boss, buy for me
I.e. I	<i>ša-ma-ma šé-bi₄-lam-ma</i>	tin, 10 minas, and send it to me and
45	<i>e-en A-šur ù e-né-kà</i>	so allow me to face Aššur and
	<i>ša-mi-ra-ni mi-nam</i>	and you!' What misdeed
	<i>ší-lá-tám</i>	have I committed
I.e. II	<i>ar-ší-a-ku-ma ù a-dí-i</i>	against you that until this
	<i>u₄-mì-im a-nim</i> AN.NA	very day you fail to send me
50	<i>lā tù-šé-ba-lam ší-im</i> KÙ.B. <i>-/pì-a</i>	the tin? Send me the tin
	AN.NA <i>šé-bi-lam</i>	bought with my silver!"

Notes

15. Either add <*i-na*> or read *ur-ki-tam* with *189:46.

21. See for the verb *anāhum*, Veenhof, *Lex.*, s.v.

32. Letter *189:30 (checked) mentions 2½ minas, but for 10 textiles, while here no number is mentioned and more (all?) textiles may have been sold.

35. I take *e-lá-ka* = *ellākka* < *ellānka*, from the preposition *a/ellān(um)*, although the form with pronominal suffix is normally *a/ellānukka*. One might emend our form to *e-lá-<nu>-kà*, but the occurrence in a letter of Šat-Aššur, BIN 4, 22:11 and 30, of *ú-lá-ku-a-tí* and *a-lá-ku-a-tí* (see *Grammar* § 14.10), in a similar phrase (*u/allākuati mamman šaniam la išū*), shows that the form in our text is perhaps possible, although it is true that BIN 4, 22 (a letter by a woman) exhibits various scribal irregularities.

45f. Facing (the god) Aššur and Ir'am-Aššur means visiting the city of Assur, which apparently depends on E. earning money by the sale of tin. Is this a matter of honor, when he has recovered and can pay his debts, or is there also a link with the fact that part of his capital consists of *ikribū* of Assur (*189:52, *190:38, *191:25), which he has to pay back?

191. Kt 91/k 407 (1-260-9)

	<i>a-na Ir-ma-A-šur qí-bi-ma</i>	Say to Ir'am-Aššur,
	<i>um-ma En-um-A-šur-ma</i>	thus Ennqm-Aššur: "I sent you
	3 <i>ma-na</i> LÁ 3 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>i-pá-ni-tim</i>	earlier 2 minas 57 shekels of silver
	<i>iš-tù Ha-tim iš-tí Šu-Sú-en₆</i>	from Hattum with Šu-Suen
5	<i>a-na Kà-ni-iš ú-šé-bi₄-lá-ku-ma</i>	to Kanesh and you brought
	KÙ.B. <i>a-na A-lim^{ki} tù-bi-il₅-ma</i>	that silver to the City, and I thought:
	[<i>um-ma</i>] <i>a-na-ku a-bi šu-ut i-lá-ak-ma'</i>	'He is my father, he will go and [bring
	[<i>iš-ŕ</i>] <i>ù A-lim^{ki}</i> AN.NA 10 <i>ma-na</i>	up] from the City tin, 10 minas, so that

	[ú-šé-lá]-ma KÙ.B 1 GÍN e-li KÙ.B	I can seal it and send at least some silver
	[a-ša ʔup-pi-a	[on top of
10	[a-kà-n]a-ak-ma ú-šé-ba-al	that (owed) according to my tablet'.
	[a-ta AN.N]A lá ta-áš-ta-ma-am	But you have not bought and sent me
	[um-ma a-ta]-ma KÙ.B a-ha-at-kà	tin, (saying): 'You sister needed
	[ta-ah-ša-ah]-ma °a-na a _i -ha-tí-kà	the silver so I gave it to you sister ^s
	[a-ša ʔup-pí-kà a-t]í-dí-šu-um-ma	[on the basis of you tablet] and ...
15	[x x x x x x x]-li-ku	
	[x x x x x x x] x *ha-ra-nim	
	[x x x x x x x] *ma x	
l.e	[	
rev	[	
20	[	
	[	
	[	
	[1 ma-na 14 G]ÍN KÙ.B ni-is-ha-[sū]	[1 mina 14] shekels of silver, its excise
	[DIRI ša-d]u-a-sú ša-bu a-ha-ma	added, its transport fee paid, and
separately		
	[½ ma-na KÙ.B] ni-is-ha-sú DIRI	[½ mina of silver], its excise added, its
	[ša-du-a-sú	[
transport fee paid,		
25	[ša-bu ik]-ri-bi ₄ ša A-šur ku-nu-ki-a,	temple funds of Aššur, I gave you under
	[IGI A]-zu-ta-a IGI Ì-dí-ba-ni	my seals in Hurama, with Azutaya
	i-na Hu-ra-ma a-dí-na-ku-um	and Idī-bāni as witnesses. I said:
	um-ma a-na-ku-ma a-bi ₄ a-ta be-lí a-ta	'Please by father, my boss, buy for
	AN.NA ša-ma-ma šé-bi ₄ - ^{la} lam	me tin and send it to me', but
30	a-ta mi-ma-ša-ma lá tù-uš-té-bi ₄ -lam	you have not sent me anything!
	TÚG.HI-tù ša i-na Lu-hu-sà-dí-a	As for the textiles you entrusted to me in
	tap-qí-da-ni ha-ra-na-tum sà-ah-a-ma	Luhusaddiya – there was trouble on the
roads		
	a-dí-i a-wa-tum iz-ku-a-ni TÚG.HI-tù	and until the affair was cleared the textiles
34	a-lá-ni-ma ib-ší-ú ITU.6.KAM	stayed in the villages. Six months ago
u.e.	i-na Hu-ra-ma gám-ra-am e-ri-/iš-kà	I asked from you in Hurama (to pay) my
	um-ma a-ta-ma a-lá-ak-ma	expenses. You said: 'I will go and
	[]š-tù Ha-hi-im AN.NA 1 ma-na	[send you] from Hahhum a few
l.e.	ù 2 ma-na [ú-šé-ba-lá-kum]	minas of tin. But you have not
	mi-ma lá tù-uš-té-[bi-lam]	sent me anything!
40	°x _i Lu-hu-<<ga>>-sá-dí-°a _i [x x x]	 Luhusaddiya

Notes

14. *190:14 shows that the dative suffix *-šumma* must be a mistake for *-šimma*.

15-21. Restoring the missing text is difficult, because what remains is not paralleled by *189 and *190, where, moreover, the various events reported occur in different order.

28. *190:43 specifies that 10 minas of tin are meant.

34. Instead of *ina alāni* in *189:19 our text has *a-lá-ni-ma*, possibly an adverbial accusative. Note that *189: 17 mentions 8 months.

Ennam-Aššur entrusts silver 74 shekels of silver, qualified as “*ikribū* of the trader” (also mentioned in *189:50, *190:36 and *191:22) to Ir'am-Aššur for transport to Assur, whereby the latter's son acts as witness.

	1 <i>ma-na</i> 14 GÍN KÙ.B. <i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>a-ha-ma</i> ½ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	1 mina 14 shekels of silver the excise on it extra, the transport fee for it paid; separately ½ mina of silver,
5	<i>ni-is-ha-sú</i> DIRI <i>ša-du-a-sú ša-bu</i> <i>ik-ri-bu ku-nu-ki</i>	the excise on it extra, the transport fee for it paid, temple funds, under the seals
l.e.	<i>ša</i> DAM.GÀR <i>En-um-A-/šur</i>	of <i>tamkārum</i> , Ennam-Aššur
rev.	<i>a-na Ir-ma-A-šur</i>	entrusted to
10	<i>ip-qí-id-ma a-na</i> <i>a-lim^{ki} a-na ší-a-ma-/tim</i> <i>ú-bi-il₅</i> IGI <i>A-zu-ta-a</i> DUMU <i>E-me-me</i>	Ir'am-Aššur and he brought it to the City for making purchases. In the presence of Azutāya, son
15	IGI <i>l-dí-ba-ni</i> DUMU <i>Ir-ma-A-šur</i> .	of Ememê, of Idī-bāni, son of Ir'am-Aššur.

Notes

7-8. “Seal of the *tamkārum*” could be used to keep the name of the owner secret, be short for “the boss (of the firm)”, or could mean “the creditor” (known to those involved), to identify the shipment of silver as a payment to him, which according to *189:42-42 // *190:10-12 was the intention of E. Since according to *190:39 the seals were those of E. himself, the first explanation is the most likely one.

10. The short “to give for making purchases” of *189:55 and *190:40-41, is here split up in “to entrust” (for transport) and “to bring for making purchases”.

13-14. The same man is attested during eponymy years REL 100 and 113. Azutāya was named after his grandfather, father of Ememe'i, attested in *59:21f. (eponymy year 90).

15. Ir'am-Aššur's son, named after his grandfather.

193. Kt 91/k 503 (1-356-9)

Near 3 minas of silver under the seal of Ennam-Aššur and meant for paying a debt of his, is entrusted to Lamassatum and Ir'am-Aššur and will be brought to Assur by the latter, but under the responsibility and at the cost of Ennam-Aššur. This silver is also mentioned in *189:38f., *190:4 and *191:3, which state that it was sent to Ir'am-Aššur (in Kanesh, *191:5) from Hattum.

	2 5/6 <i>ma-na</i> 7 G[IN] °KÙ.B. <i>ku-nu-ki ša En-um-/A-šur</i> DUMU <i>E-lá-ma</i> <i>Šu-Sú-in</i> DUMU <i>l-lí-a</i>	2 minas 57 shekels of silver under the seals of Ennam-Aššur, son of Elamma, Šu-Suen, son of Iliya,
5	<i>a-na Lá-ma-sí-tim</i> <i>ù Ir-ma-A-šur ip-qí-id-/ma</i>	entrusted to Lamassutum and Ir'am-Aššur and

	KÙ.B. <i>Ir-ma-A-šur</i>	Ir'am-Aššur will bring
	<i>a-na a-lim^{ki} A-šur</i>	the silver to the
9	<i>ú-ba-al-šu a-na</i>	city of Assur . He
l.e.	<i>hu-bu-ul</i>	will pay it for
rev.	<i>En-um-A-šur</i>	the debt of Ennam-Aššur
	<i>a-na DAM.GÀR i-ša-qal</i>	to the creditor.
	KÙ.B. <i>a-šu-mi En-um-A-šur</i>	The silver will travel overland
	<i>GÁN-lam e-tí-iq</i>	in the name of Ennam-Aššur.
15	IGI <i>Pi-lá-ah-lštar DUMU E-/lá-ma</i>	Witnessed by Pilah-lštar, son of Elamma,
	IGI <i>A-šur-ba-ni DUMU</i>	and by Aššur-bāni, son of
	<i>Du-mu-uq-lštar</i>	Dumuq-lštar.

Notes

4. Textiles of this man, sealed by Ennam-Aššur, are mentioned in *166:4f.

194. Kt 92/k 174 (1-134-92)

Dān-Aššur and Ennam-Suen, his representatives (see *189:30), inform Ir'am-Aššur about the sale "here" (in Wahšušana, see *189:22) of a lot of textiles brought them by Ennam-Aššur, and latter eventually managed to sell them in Šaladuwar and is now on his way to him with its yield.

	<i>um-ma Dan-A-šur ù</i>	Thus Dān-Aššur and
	<i>En-na-Sú-in-ma</i>	Ennam-Suen, say to
	<i>a-na Ir-ma-A-šur qí-bi₄-ma</i>	Ir'am-Aššur:
	10 TÚG.HI.A <i>ku-nu-ki ša</i>	"10 textiles with the seals of
5	<i>Ku-lu-ma-a En-um-A-šur</i>	Kulumāya Ennam-Aššur
	<i>ub-lam ŠÀ.BA 2 TÚG</i>	brought us. Two of these are
	<i>a-bar-ni-ú 1 TÚG</i>	Abarnian ones, one is a
	<i>na-ma-šu-hu-um</i>	<i>namaššuhu</i> -textile.
	<i>ki-ma a-na-kam</i>	Since there is no possibility
10 e.	<i>ší-mu-um lá-šu-ú</i>	to sell them here
	<i>ù TÚG.HI-tù</i>	and these textiles
rev.	<i>sá-sà-am lá-áp-tù</i>	are affected by moth,
	<i>En-um-A-šur a-na</i>	Ennam-Aššur
	<i>Ša-lá-du-a-ar</i>	brought them into
15	<i>ú-šé-ri-ib-šu-nu-ma</i>	Šaladuwar and
	15 GÍN.TA <i>ší-im-šu-nu</i>	he gave us 15 shekels apiece,
	<i>i-dí-ni-a-tí-ma 2½ ma-/na</i>	the price made for them, and
	KÙ.B. <i>ku-nu-ki-ni</i>	Ennam-Aššur is now on his way
	<i>En-um-A-šur</i>	to you with 2½ minas of
20	<i>na-áš-a-ku-um a-ma-kam</i>	silver under our seals. Over there
u.e.	<i>a-na TÚG.HI.A A-al-DÙG</i>	let Āl-tāb get a judicial clearance
	<i>i-dí-nim iš-tí-kà</i>	with you concerning
l.e.e.	<i>li-iz-ku</i>	these textiles.

Notes

5. Kulumāya's seals are also mentioned in *190:29

6-7. The presence of a few expensive items among the textiles explains that the price eventually made for them, on average 15 shekels a piece, is considered to be low.

12. The delay of the sale and long storage in bags or chests, without airing them, apparently was responsible for the damaged caused by moths, see below, "Interpretation", c), and Michel 1998, 328f., supplemented Michel-Veenhof 2010, 213 with note 14.

20-23. These lines suggest that the (reason for the) low yield of these textiles has to be acknowledged by what probably is their owner in a formal judicial procedure, perhaps one where an oath was sworn and accounts settled; see for such cases *EL* 261, 269-270; ICK 2, 113 and 139; AKT 3, 57; Prag I 716. How Āl-ṭāb was involved in this transaction is unclear, and we also do not know what is implied by the fact that the lot was shipped "under the seal of Kulumāya" (lines 4-5).

Interpretation

These six documents document the rather difficult relations between Elamma's son Ennam-Aššur (E.) and his senior brother-in-law Ir'am-Aššur (I.), who was married to E.'s sister Šalimma (cf. Ch. XII). E. is engaged in the trade in tin and textiles and also handles merchandise belonging to I. (190*:21, "my textiles", which he entrusts to him, *191:31-32) and he seems to be in financial problems, because he has to pay one or more creditors in Assur. The background could be the death of his father (who is not mentioned; his mother Lamassutum features in *193:5) and the ensuing liquidation of his business, which must have entailed the payment of his debts by his sons. In this his sister in Assur, Ummī-lšhara, must have played a role and this could be the reason why she "needed" (*hašāhum*) silver of E. sent to Assur (*189:44-45, *190:13, *191:12-13). E. also encountered problems in Anatolia, because he had been stuck in Hattum for eight months, presumably due to political troubles. He utters various complaints against I., because the latter did not pay him his travel expenses and did not live up to his promises of providing him with tin from Assur. The documents illustrate the problems a junior trader might run into and his dependence on the cooperation with a senior partner. The differences between the texts show that the same events could be portrayed in different perspective, partly also in different order, which may reflect the mood of the rather desperate E. who, not without some rhetorical skill, mixes complaints with appeals for help and a plea for sticking to promises. The letters are also interesting in showing the commercial realities and problems that are at the basis of seemingly simple transport contracts and consignments. The following sketch of the events divides them into various episodes.

a) Mentioned first in *190:4-14//*191:3-14 and later in *189:38-45: Some time ago ("pre-viously" in *190 and *191) E. had sent 2 minas 57 shekels of silver with (*ištī*) Šu-Suen, son of Iliya, from Hattum to I. in Kanesh (*191:5), asking him to take it along to Assur. This is also recorded in the undated contract *193, whereby Šu-Suen hands this silver over to E.'s mother and I. in order to have the latter bring it to Assur in order "to pay it for the debt E. owes to *tamkārum*", his creditor or boss. In the letters (*189:40-41 // *190:7-8) however, E. states that I. was to use it to buy tin for him, "some 10 minas" (*190:8), to be sent to him in Anatolia (*189:41, *ušellām*, *190:8, *ušebbalam*). There it could be sold by E. with profit and the silver earned in this way (*189:42//*190:10, *kaspum elliam*) would be used to pay his creditor/boss (*tamkārum*), "on the basis of my tablet"; *189:42-3 writes "I will pay silver to my *tamkārum* and (to do so?) send it" (to Assur); *190:10-12 is shorter, "I will send the silver to my *tamkārum*". Was this the original intention or a later adaptation of the goal (by inserting an

intermediary step), stipulated in contract *193? In Assur, however (*189:44-45 // *190:13), as I. had told him, E.'s sister, no doubt the priestess Ummī-lšhara, required the silver and I. had given it to her, *ana ša tuppika* (*189:45//*190:14//*191:14). This suggests that there was a contractual basis for it, possibly a recorded liability or promise of E., perhaps the basis for the stipulation in text *193 that I. would use the silver to pay E.'s debts. I assume that Ummī-lšhara's "need" for the silver was due to the fact that, after their father's death, she was engaged in liquidating his firm, which implied paying the commercial debts that were the liability of the male heirs, her brothers. She accordingly must have obliged I. to give her the silver E. had earned and not use it for a new commercial enterprise. The same feature can be observed after Pūšu-kēn's death, when his daughter in Assur, Ahaha, is desperately trying to pay the family's debts, while her brothers in Anatolia only think of trading.

b) Having disappointed E. by the outcome of a) I., "later" (*urkītam* *189:46//190:15), when he was about to leave (for Assur?), came up with a new plan to help E. and "give him courage" (*189:46-49//190:15-20). E. has to give him all the silver he has available and I. will buy for him 10 minas of tin, which will allow E. to earn money. E. manages to collect the modest sum of 1 mina 44 shekels of silver (*189:50-52//190:36-39//191:22-25), sufficient to buy tin in Assur (normally at a rate of ca. 15 shekels of tin for 1 shekel of silver), which he "gave to I. for making purchases" (*189:54) in Hurama, as witnessed by A. and I. (*190:39-40//191:26-27), "under my seals" (*190:39//191:25). This transaction is recorded in *192, witnessed by the same two men, but here (lines 7-8) the silver is said to be "under the seals of *tamkārum*", which means of its anonymous owner, perhaps to prevent other creditors of E. to seize it. Since the transaction is for the benefit of E. he has to pay for the costs of the transport, both the "excise" and the "transport fee", as *189:50-51//*190:37 and *192:2-6 duly mention. *189:54 then continues with E.'s complaint that in exchange for this silver I. has thus far not sent him any tin and in lines 56-57 asks to do so now; cf. *190:43-44, where E. also asks what he has done wrong (*šillatam rašā'um*) to earn this treatment.

c) In *190: 21-34 this sad story is preceded by a report about problems with the sale of a lot of textiles (*190:21, "my textiles"), which I. had entrusted (*paqādum*) to E. in Luhusaddiya (*191:31-32). A situation with unsafe roads (stative of *sahā'um*, D-stem) and unyielding local palaces (*dannum*, *189:16) had obliged E. to wait many months "in the interior" until the trade could be resumed, 8 months in *189:17, 7 months in *190:26 and 6 months in *191:34! The delay had also caused damage of the textiles by moths, apparently because they had not been regularly aired. When they had been finally "salvaged" (*šalāhum*) their sale proved difficult and their yield was poor, on average only 15 shekels of silver apiece, in all 2½ minas (the 3½ minas of *190:32 may be a mistake). This silver had been received (?) and sealed by I.'s representatives, but had not yet been shipped off (*189:29-32//*190:32:34, *ša kīma kuāti*, plural // *šazzuzātika*^{sic}, cf. *šazzuzātika* in I. 30). Letter *190:32-37 reveals that this was because I.'s plan to let E.'s sister, in this case to all appearances I.'s wife Šalimma (who stayed in Kanesh), take it along on her intended journey to Assur, had failed, because she could not travel due to severe cold in Central Anatolia.

This story is confirmed by letter *194, written by Dān-Aššur and Ennam-Suen, who must be I.'s "representatives" mentioned in *189:31. They offer a few more details on the composition of the lot of textiles, sealed by Kulumāya (also mentioned in *190:29), which had been delivered to them by E. While *189:22 simply states that E. had brought the textiles to I.'s representatives in Wahšušana, *194:9-15 write that,

because they could not be sold “here” and because they had been affected by moths, they were subsequently brought by E. to Šaladuwar, further to the west, and were sold there. Then – so we must assume - E. returned to Wahšušana, presented the silver earned to I.’s representatives, which they had him bring to I. (in Kanesh?) under their seals. This story of the textiles features also in *189:14-32, before episodes **a**) and **b**), as continuation of E.’s complaint that he still had not received compensation for his travel expenses (see below **d**). This is understandable, since for I. the salvage of the textiles was a condition for paying them.

d) The issue of the travel expenses (*gamrum ša harrānim*) to which E. is entitled forms the beginning of *189. It was raised in Hurama, where both men met and had a discussion (lines 2-11) and the expenses were those of transporting the textiles, incurred either to get them in Hurama or (more likely) to ship them on, possibly to “Hattum”. It is not certain that this is the lot of textiles entrusted to E. in Luhusaddiya according to *191:31-32, because this town is situated north of Hurama, where the discussion about the expenses took place (*189:3). That I. had to pay expenses and wrote for E. a “document concerning the textiles” (see the note on *189:3) indicates that the textiles belonged to I. and that E. handled them for him (alongside his own business, such as the trade in tin). I. had given him only a little silver, refused to pay E.’s expenses cash (*190:7-8, *ana qātim tadānum*) and would pay them only after (*adi*, I. 9) E. had salvaged the textiles (*šalāhum*, *189:9, cf. *šēšu’um*, ‘to get out’, I. 20), by sending him silver from Hahhum, which he failed to do. E. then reminds him of the serious problems encountered, apparently unknown to I., and tells how thanks to the pains he took (*anāhum*) the textiles are safe, although at the cost of expenses equal to the price of three textiles. Text *190 gives a somewhat different picture by linking episode **b**) with the salvaging of the textiles and by making the latter an order of I. and thus a condition for his help (*190:21-22): “You said: Exert yourself for my textiles and salvage what you can, so that they do not get lost!”

The geographical data of the texts have been studied in *Geography* 137f., 159f., with the partly duplicating footnotes 437-8 and 546-7, where Barjamovic quotes and discusses texts *189 and *191, that I had made available to him. He describes Luhuzaddiya as “located on a separate route that branched out from the main Euphrates route in Hurama” and passed Kuššara, Šamuha and Kuburnat to arrive at Durhumit, thus connecting the south with Hattum, which he defines as the eastern part of Central Anatolia, “linked to the clusters east of Kanesh” (p. 164). He then offers the following reconstruction, into which I insert between brackets some data, referring to the texts of our file: “More than 6 months beforehand, while Ennam-Aššur was in Luhuzattiya, Irma-Aššur sent him a letter (from Hurama? *189:3 – K.R.V.), some silver and an order on what to do with a consignment of textiles arriving in Hurama from Assur. Thereupon (*189:14f. // *190:23f.) Irma-Aššur continued his journey to Hahhum, where he stayed for a while (*189:10-13) before finally leaving for Assur (implied by *189:41ff.). In the meantime Ennam-Aššur went to Hattum (also referred to as *libbi mātim*) (*189:18 – K.R.V.), but unrest broke out and the consignment had to be stored in villages there (*189:19). Once the situation had settled down, Ennam-Aššur sent the goods from Hattum to Wahšušana (*189:21-22, cf. *190:30). Furthermore, he sent Šu-Suen from Hattum to Irma-Aššur in Kaneš with a sum of money (*189:39, *190:5-6).”

A slight modification of this picture is that at the start I. himself was apparently present in Hurama, where he instructed E. about how to ship the silver earned by the textiles to Assur (*189:32f.) and where E. (on the same occasion?) gave him the 1

mina 44 shekels of silver (*190:40, *191:27, cf. *192). This asks for a different meaning for the “missive” (*našpertum*) I. gave to E. there (see note on *189:3). The main question, also raised by the different order in which our sources relate the events, is whether all refer to one single journey, from Hurama to Luhusaddiya, to Hattum, to Wahššušana, to Šaladuwar and perhaps eventually back to Kanesh. I find it difficult to assume that E.’s activity in Hattum, mentioned at the beginning of *190 (line 4, “previously”) was in consequence of the meeting with I. in Hurama and the acceptance of a consignment of textiles in Luhusaddiya. *191:31ff. indicate that the textiles suffered under the long delay “in the interior” of Hattum and the position of *189:15ff. also suggests that the meeting in Hurama (*190:3) preceded these events. If so, the shipment by E. of almost 3 minas of silver of his to I. in Kanesh (*190:4ff., *189:38ff.) must have preceded these events and points to an earlier stay of E. in Hattum, which he may have interrupted in order to come to Luhusaddiya / Hurama to receive a new consignment. Why this consignment was picked up in Luhusaddiya (*191:31), after a meeting in the more southern Hurama, is unclear. *Geography* 135 mentions that “one could travel directly from Timilkiya to Luhusaddiya and so avoid taxation in Šalahšuwa and Hurama, but this required a royal guide or smuggling”, but these are not mentioned in our text.

B. Various documents (173-175)

195. Kt 91/k 455 (1-308-91)

A letter of Ir'am-Aššur, perhaps sent from Assur, to three persons in Kanesh about a payment they have to make for him, about how they should act in connection with a shipment of silver, and that they have to retrieve for him the tablets recording debts he has paid in the mean time. The letter (or a copy of it) turned up in the archive, because Elamma's son and widow are among the addressees.

	<i>um-ma Ir-ma-A-šù[r-ma a-na]</i>	Thus Ir'am-Aššur, say to
	<i>I-ku-pí-A-šùr Lá-m[a-sà-tim]</i>	Ikuppi-Aššur, Lam[assutum]?
	<i>ù En-um-A-šùr qí-bi-ma</i>	and Ennam-Aššur:
	<i>1 ma-na KÙ.B. ku-nu-ku-a : ša</i>	“1 mina of silver under my seals,
5	<i>Sú-en₆-na-da : a-ma-kam : a-na</i>	belonging to Suen-nādā, you must give
	<i>Šu-Lá-ba-an ù Ku-ra-ra dí-na-šu</i>	there to Šu-Labān and Kurara
	<i>ù ší-bé šu-uk-na ki-ma KÙ.B.</i>	and you must set witnesses
	<i>ša Sú-en₆-na-da °il₅-qé-ú-ni</i>	that they received Suen-nādā's silver.
	<i>3 ma-na KÙ.B. ša DAM.GÀR ku-nu-ku-a</i>	With 3 minas of silver of the trader,
10	<i>a-na še-er A-šur-GAL °EN.LÍL-ba-ni</i>	under my seals, I sent Ellil-bāni, son of
	<i>DUMU Ha-na-nim ú-še-bi-lam</i>	Hanānum, to Aššur-rabi.
	<i>a-ša-me-ma : a-dí-ni : a-ma-kam</i>	I hear that he is still staying there
	<i>wa-ša-áb : šu-ma a-na pá-ni</i>	and if he has indeed not left
l.e.	<i>A-šur-GAL : lá i-lí-ik</i>	to meet Aššur-rabi, then
rev.	<i>KÙ.B. pu-uṭ-ra-ma AN.NA</i>	unpack the silver and buy for me
16	<i>lu 9 GÍN.TA lu ma-lá</i>	tin at 9 shekels per (shekel of silver)
	<i>ta-le-e-a-ni ša-ma-ma</i>	or as favorably as you can.
	<i>°EN.LÍL-ba-ni ù °UTU-e-nam</i>	Send Ellil-bāni and Šamaš-ennam
	<i>KI a-lí-ki-im pá-nim-ma</i>	here with the first caravan.

- 20 *ṭur₄-da-nim : a-šu-mi ṭup-pé-a* As for my tablets, according to which
ša a-na l-na-a DUMU E-lá-lí I became indebted to Innāya, son of Elālī,
En-na-Sú-en₆ DUMU Šu-lštar to Ennam-Suen, son of Šu-lštar, and
ù A-šur-ma-lík DUMU Qá-a-tim to Aššur-mālik, son of Qa'ātum,
 KÙ.B. *a-hi-ib-lu* KÙ.B. *ú-šé-bi-lá-/* I have sent them the silver, they
 25 *ša-bu-ú : ṭup-pé-a iš-tí [šu-nu-tí]* are satisfied. Are my tablets with
Lá-ma-sà-tim i-ba-ší-ú Lamassutum or does someone
lu [ma]-ma-an i-na ša-zu-uz-[tí-a] from my representatives have them
 u.e. *°ú₂-kà-al-šu-nu : a-dí [ma-lā]* in his possession? I have written
 29 *ú ší-ni-šu áš-pu-r[á-ku-nu-tí]* you several times. Why has
 le.e. *[m]i-šu-um : ma-tí-ma : té-er-ta-ku-/nu* no report of yours ever
lá i-lí-kam-ma úz-ni reached me and do you not
lá ta-pá-tí-a keep me informed?

Notes

2. Ikuppi-Aššur must be the same man as in *240:16, where he figures alongside Ir'am-Aššur. I have restored Lamassutum's name, because she should be informed about Ir'am-Aššur's request about debt-notes that could be in her house (lines 25-26, presumably after the death of Elamma).

6. Šu-Labān could be the man who had invested in Elamma's joint-stock capital, *2:3.

9. It is not clear whether *tamkārum* here means "the creditor" (whose name is not revealed) or "the (main) trader", who could be Elamma.

10, 14. Aššur-rabi – if it is the same man – was in Ir'am-Aššur's as harnesser, who had received from him a "working capital" (*200). This fits the fact that the silver is sent *ana pānišu*, which usually means that it has to reach him en route.

16. The price of tin points to purchase in Anatolia; in Assur it was much cheaper.

27. My original hesitation about the singular *šazzuztum* is not necessary, see *Grammar* § 21.9, on "deviations of number agreement", where AKT 6, 229:12, *nēnu šazzuztum ša PN* is quoted.

A verdict of the Kanesh colony

196. Kt 91/k 480 (1-333-91)

Verdict of the plenary assembly of the Kanesh colony, in an unopened black envelope, with impressions of seven different cylinder seals, obliging Ir'am-Aššur to pay the working capital of Zikum to Aššur-idī.

- | | | |
|------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| | KIŠIB <i>kà-ri-im Kà-ni-iš</i> | Seal of the Kanesh colony |
| | seal A | |
| | <i>ša-he-er GAL kà-ru-um</i> | in plenary session. The Kanesh |
| | <i>Kà-ni-iš</i> | colony in |
| | seal B | |
| l.e. | seal C | |
| rev. | seal D | |
| | <i>ša-he-er GAL</i> | plenary session |
| 5 | <i>dí-nam</i> | passed the following |
| | <i>[i₂-di-in-ma</i> | verdict: |

	[x m]a-na KÙ.B.	‘[x] mina of silver,
	[be-ú-lā]-at Zi-ki-im	[the working] capital of Zikum
	[a-n]a A-šūr-i-dī	to Aššur-idī
10	[l]i-ma-A-šūr	Ir’am-Aššur
u.e.	seal E	
	i-ša-qal	shall pay’.
le.e.	seal F	
ri.e.	seal G	

Seals

A=CS 1212; B=CS 1213; C=CS 1214; D=CS 1215; E=CS 1216; G=CS 1218; F=C1217.

Unfortunately, none of the seals of these men representing the colony, all without inscription, could be identified by Mrs. Omura with impressions known from other envelopes.

Notes

7. The restored figure [1/2] takes into account to room available and the fact that this was very often the size of the *be’ulātum*.

Comment

This verdict is sealed by seven persons representing the colony. See for similar envelopes sealed by (representatives of) the colony OACC 1976, 299f., and Hecker 2003,190-196, to which one may now add for the Kanesh colony AKT 6-a, 61 (8 seals), 80 (5 seals), and Kt 94/k 301 (6 seals), and for the Šimala colony Kt c/k 647 (courtesy of Dercksen), with 5 different seals. Why the number of sealers/representatives varies between five and eight is not clear.

Debt-notes

197. Kt 91/k 504 (1-357-91)

A debt-note dated to eponymy year REL 92, recording that Imlik-Aššur owes Ir’am-Aššur a small amount of gold, payable within 15 weeks.

	°2 _z GÍN KÙ.KI	2 shekels of <i>kupuršinnu</i> -
	ku-pu-ur-šī-ni-in	gold of fine quality
	SIG ₅ i-še-er	Imlik-Aššur
	Im-lik-A-šur Ir-ma-A-šur	owes to Ir’am-Aššur.
5	i-šu iš-tù ha-mu(1R)-uš-tim	From the week of
	ša E-dī-na-a : a-na	Edināya he
	15 ha-am-ša-tim	will pay within 15
	i-ša-qal šu-ma	weeks. If he does
9	lā iš-qul ki-ma	not pay he will add (interest)
l.e.	a-wa-at kà-ri-im	in accordance with the regulation
	ú-ša-áb ITI.KAM	of the colony.
rev.	qá-ra-a-tim	Month VIII,
	li-mu-um E-lā-lí	year eponymy of Elālī,
	DUMU I-ku-nim	son of Ikūnum.
15	IGI Pí-lā-ah-A-šur	In the presence of Pilah-Aššur,
	DUMU Da-nu-um-i-lí	son of Dannum-ilī,

IGI A-šur-ma-lik
DUMU A-zu-za

of Aššur-mālik,
son of Azuza.

Notes

2. In 2 *šiglēn kupuršinnēn* the item counted is in apposition to the numeral, but the constructions attested for *kupuršinnum* are not uniform: BIN 6, 137:2, $1\frac{1}{2}$ GÍN GUŠKIN SIG5 *ku-pu-ur-ší-ni-im* *addin*, and Kt c/k 1102:4, $5\frac{1}{2}$ GÍN *ku-pu-ur-ší-ni*, might be interpreted (as Kouwenberg observes) as genitives after a measure, but BIN 6, 90:14, 10 GÍN KÜ.KI *ku-pu-ur-ší-NIM* (*nām?*), and TC 3, 43:8, $\frac{1}{2}$ *ma-na* GUŠKIN *ku-pu-ur-ší-NIM* (a nominative in a list?) suggest that the case ending could be conditioned by the syntax of the sentence. But this is not the case in TC 1, 47:17, GUŠKIN ... *ku-pu-ur-ší-nu-um mamman ..la ušebbalam*. The exchange rate against silver, 1: $6\frac{2}{3}$ in TC 3, 43:9, shows that *kupuršinnum* is a cheaper kind of gold.

17-18. The same man occurs during the same eponymy year as debtor in Kt c/k 839:101f.

198. Kt 91/k 525 (1-378-91)

A small, damaged and crumbling debt-note dated to eponymy year REL 96 or 100, recording the remainder of a debt owed by Ir'am-Aššur, but the name of the creditor is not mentioned. The tablet that starts with the list of the sealers is a copy of the text on the envelope of the debt-note. It may have been written for Ir'am-Aššur's administration after the debt had been paid and the original debt-note returned.

	KIŠIB <i>l-lí-áš-ra-ni</i>	Seal of Ilī-ašranni,
	DUMU A-šur-DÙG KIŠIB	son of Aššur-ṭāb, seal of
	Šu-Sú-in DUMU <i>Da-dí-im</i>	Šu-Suen, son of Dadum,
	KIŠIB <i>E-nu-Bé-lúm ša ší-tí</i>	seal of Ennam-Bēlum, of the remainder
5	<i>ša °hu-bu-ul₂ Ir-ma-A-šur</i>	of the debt of Ir'am-Aššur.
	<i>i-na ITI 1.KAM Bé-el-tí-É-/GAL</i>	In the month I,
	<i>li-mu-um ša qá-té</i>	eponymy of the successor
	<i>[A-šū]r-na-da a-na</i>	of Aššur-nādā, to
	<i>[x x nim² i-ša-qal</i>	[.....] he will pay.
10	<i>[šū-ma lá iš-qul]</i>	[If he does not pay]
l.e.	<i>[1 1/2 GÍN.TA]</i>	[$1\frac{1}{2}$ shekels per]
rev.	<i>[1 ma-na]-um ki-ma</i>	mina, in accordance with
	<i>[a-wa]-at kà-ri-im</i>	the regulation of the colony
	<i>ší-ib-tám</i>	he will add
15	<i>i-na ITI.KAM-im</i>	as interest
	<i>ú-ša-áb</i>	per month.

Notes

1. The first witness could be the same man as mentioned in *311:12 (witness) and *143:8 (recipient of beer).

4. *ša* functions as relative pronoun in a nominal sentence, not as a conjunction ("that"), since *išaqqal* in l. 9 is in the indicative.

9. *-nim²* is probably the end of a personal name.

199. Kt 91/k 523 (1-376-91)

A contract recording a silver debt dated to eponymy year REL 94, which Ir'am-Aššur, Irišum and Ilī-wedāku owe to Ušur-ša-Aššur, payable within four weeks, with a stipulation which weighing stone is to be used to determine the amount.

	<i>⅔ ma-na KÙ.B. ṣa-ru-pá-am</i>	⅔ mina of refined silver -
	<i>i-na ma-na-im</i>	it was cut off using the (1) mina
	<i>ša A-mur-^dUTU ba-lúm du-na-e</i>	weight of Amur-Šamaš,
	<i>i-ta-ki-is i-še-er</i>	without surcharge -
5	<i>Ir-ma-A-šūr I-ri-ší-im</i>	Ir'am-Aššur, Irišum
	<i>ù Ilī-me-ta-ku</i>	and Ilī-wedāku owe to
	<i>Ú-šur-ša-A-šūr i-šu</i>	Ušur-ša-Aššur.
	<i>iš-tù ha-muš-tim</i>	From the week of
	<i>ša A-šūr-i-dí</i>	Aššur-idī and
i.e.	<i>ù Šu-lštar ITI.KAM</i>	Šu-lštar, month
11	<i>kan-wa-ar-ta</i>	IX, eponymy year
rev.	<i>li-mu-um ^dIŠKUR-ba-ni</i>	of Adad-bāni,
	<i>a-na 4 ha-am-ša-tim</i>	they will pay within 4 weeks.
	<i>i-ša-qú-lu šu-ma lá iš-qú-lu</i>	If they do not pay they will
15	<i>1½ GÍN.TA i-ITI.KAM-im</i>	add (an interest of) 1½ shekel
	<i>ú-šú-bu KÙ.B. i-qá-qá-ad</i>	per mina per month. They are
	<i>šál-mi-šu-nu ra-ki-is</i>	jointly liable for the silver.
	<i>IGI DÙG-A-šur</i>	In the presence of Ṭāb-Aššur,
	<i>IGI Šu-lštar</i>	of Šu-lštar.

Notes

2-4. See for this way of describing how the correct weight was established by using the weight of a particular person by the “cutting off” (*nakāsum*), while excluding the addition an kind of “surtax” (*dunnā'ū*), AOATT 64-68. But the interpretation and explanation of the forms of the verb *nakāsum* remain difficult; see Veenhof *Lex.*, s.v. *nakās/šum*.

3. The use of Amur-Šamaš's weight suggests that he was somehow associated with the creditor, but it is impossible to identify him without the name of his father. In Elamma's archive we find two men of that name, sons of Harimtum and Mīšar-rabi, and both figure as witness in *190:9-11. Amur-Šamaš may have been identical to the father of the debtor Irišum, mentioned in the memorandum Kt 91/k 141:44.

5. Ir'am-Aššur's co-debtors, hard to identify without patronyms, occur only in this text.

8. The sign MUŠ has a peculiar shape.

Comment

A relatively small debt of 40 shekels of silver, jointly owed by three persons, is uncommon and its nature is note revealed. The presence of this debt-note in the archive of Elamma may indicate that Ir'am-Aššur had paid the debt and retained the debt-note, perhaps in order to charge his co-debtors for their share in it.

200. Kt 91/k 325 (1-182-91)

The text of an undated *be'ūlātu*-contract, perhaps kept by the creditor/employer after the silver had been paid back and its envelope had been removed.

	$\frac{2}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. <i>ša-ru-pá-am</i> <i>bé-ú-la-tim</i> <i>ša Ir-ma-A-šùr</i>	$\frac{2}{3}$ mina of refined silver, the working capital of Ir'am-Aššur,
5	<i>A-šùr-GAL</i> <i>ú-kà-al</i> <i>iš-tí</i> KÙ.B. <i>A-šùr-GAL</i>	Aššur-rabi has in his possession. With the silver Aššur-rabi
rev	<i>uk-ta-al</i>	is held (in service).
10	IGI <i>A-šùr-GAL</i> IGI <i>En-um-A-šùr</i> (remainder not inscribed)	Witnessed by Aššur-rabi, by Ennam-Aššur

Notes

10. While one may expect the debtor to have sealed the envelope of this contract, the witness Aššur-rabi must be a different person. The debtor, who had received a “working capital” to serve Ir'am-Aššur as transporter, could perhaps be the man of that name in *195:13-14, where silver is sent “to meet him” (en route, *ana pāni* A.).

A quittance

201. Kt 91/k 516 (1-369-91)

An unopened envelope containing a quittance for the payment by Aššur-ṭāb of a very small silver debt owed by Ir'am-Aššur to Puzur-lštar. It is dated to eponymy year REL 108, rather than 116. Aššur-ṭāb may have been the son of Elamma or his namesake, son of his brother Ali-ahum.

	KIŠIB <i>Šu-mi-a-bi₄-a</i> DUMU <i>A-ba-ra-a</i> seal A	Seal of Šumi-abia, son of Abaraya,
	KIŠIB <i>En-na-nim</i> DUMU <i>Šu-Hu-bur</i> KIŠIB <i>Puzur₄-lštar</i> DUMU <i>A-šùr-ták-lá-ku</i>	seal of Ennānum, son of Šu-Hubur, seal of Puzur-lštar, son of
	Aššur-taklāku. $3 \frac{2}{3}$ G ₂ [IN K]Ù.B. <i>ša-ru-pá-am</i> seal B	3 $\frac{2}{3}$? shekels of refined silver
5	<i>a-na Puzur₄-lštar a-šu-mi</i> l.e. seal B (upside down)	Aššur-ṭāb paid to
	<i>Ir-ma-A-šùr A-šùr-DÙG</i> <i>iš-qú-ul a-na mi-ma</i>	Puzur-lštar in the name of Ir'am-Aššur.
rev.	<i>šu-um-šu Puzur₄-lštar</i> seal C (upside down)	Puzur-lštar will not come back for
	<i>a-na Ir-ma-A-šur lá i-tù-ar</i> 10 <i>iš-tù ha-muš-tim ša Kur-ub-lštar</i> ITI.KAM <i>ša sá-ra-tim</i> seal C (upside down)	anything, whatsoever, on Ir'am-Aššur. From the week of Kurub-lštar, month III of the
	<i>li-mu-um ša qá-té</i> u.e. seal A	eponymy of the successor of
	<i>En-na-Sú-in</i>	Ennam-Suen

le.e. seal A
r.e. seal ?

Seals

seal A = CS 77, inscription: *A-šur-ta-°ak₂-[lá-ku]* / DUMU *Puzur₄-[lštar]*, also impressed as seal B on the bulla Kt n/k 1717. Its user was the creditor Puzur-lštar, who must have inherited his father's seal without adapting the inscription, perhaps because he was named after his grandfather.

seal B = CS 1226

seal C = CS 1227

Notes

1-2. The two witnesses who sealed this record are not attested in other texts of the archive.

4. The faint traces after the numeral make G[IN] more likely than *m[a-na]*.

12-13. The eponym, without patronym, most probably was the successor of REL 107 and not of REL 115, since the latest eponymy in a record mentioning Ir'am-Aššur is REL 109.

Comment

Such a quittance was issued when the original debt-note could not (yet) be returned. The clause normally present in such quittances, "when the (original) debt-note turns up it is invalid" is lacking and this quittance was also not exchanged for the original debt-note, after which both tablets could be cancelled.

202. Kt 91/k 492 (1-345-91)

A note on four amounts of silver, in all 4½ minas plus some interest, the assets of an anonymous writer that he "left" for collection to Ir'am-Aššur. That the latter is entitled to take ca. two-thirds of it for himself suggests that the writer ceded claims to his creditor, who could collect them and thereby indemnify himself, but had to return the surplus to his debtor. The odd amount of line 10 may be a the remainder of a debt or the purchase price of merchandise, not the amount of a normal loan.

	2 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	2 minas of silver
	<i>a-Ba-zi-a</i>	for Baziya;
	1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	1 mina of silver
	<i>ù ší-ba-sú</i>	with the interest on it
5	<i>ša Dan-A-šur</i>	of Dān-Aššur;
	1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. É <i>kà-ri-/im</i>	1 mina of silver of the colonial office;
	½ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	½ mina of silver
	<i>Wa-wa-li</i>	Wawali (and)
9	<i>A-šur-i-mi-ti</i>	Aššur-imittī -
l.e.	ŠÀ.BA 2½ <i>ma-na</i> ½ GÍN	Of this Ir'am-Aššur will take
rev.	KÙ.B. <i>Ir-ma-A-šur</i>	2 minas 30½ shekels
	<i>i-lá-qé mi-ma</i>	of silver. All this
	<i>a-nim a-na Ir-ma-A-šur</i>	I left to Ir'am-Aššur,
	<i>e-zi-ib</i> IGI <i>Šu-lštar</i>	in the presence of Šu-lštar,
15	DUMU <i>Da-da-nim</i>	son of Dadānum,
	IGI <i>Sà-ba-sí-a</i>	and of Sabasiya.

Notes

2-9. The variation between “silver *ana* PN / *ša* PN / PN” is confusing. That the size of the amount of l. 10 that Ir'am-Aššur will take “thereof” (ŠÀ.BA) is bigger than the sum of the amounts listed in lines 3-7, implies that it is part of the sum of the four amounts mentioned in lines 2-7 that were “left to him” and that this included the amount “for Baziya” of lines 1-2.

14f. This witness also occurs in ATHE 1:1, from month X of eponymy year REL 81.

Two judicial records

203. Kt 91/k 494 (1-347-91)

The certified record of a testimony given before the Kanesh colony by one of the two witnesses or arbitrators “seized” when Puzur-Aššur and Ir'am-Aššur confronted each other in Assur and reached an agreement.

	<i>Puzur₄-A-šùr ù Ir-ma-Ašur</i>	Puzur-Aššur and Ir'am-Aššur
	<i>i-na a-lim^{ki} iṣ-bu-tù-ni-a-ti-ma</i>	seized us in the City and
	<i>um-ma Ir-ma-A-šùr-ma a-na</i>	Ir'am-Aššur said to
	<i>Puzur₄-A-šùr-ma ṭup-pé-a</i>	Puzur-Aššur: “You gained access to
5	<i>i-na Wa-ah-šu-ša-na : ta-áp-té-[m]a</i>	my tablets in Wahšušana and
	<i>ṭup-pá-am ša 4:5 ⅔ ma-na 5 GÍN KÙ.B.</i>	you took a tablet of 45 shekels of
	silver	
	<i>ša Pí-lá-ha-a-nim DUMU Da-nu-um-i-[l]l</i>	of Pilahānum, son of Dannum-ilī,
	<i>tal-qé ṭup-pá-am : ša 15 GÍN KÙ.[B.]</i>	(and) you took a tablet of 15 shekels
	<i>ša Kà-as-kà-nu-i-il₅ : tal-q[é]</i>	of silver of Kaskanu'ilī.
10	<i>um-ma Puzur₄-A-šur-ma : ke-na</i>	Puzur-Aššur answered: “Indeed,
	<i>al-qé ša-zu-uz-ti : a-ta</i>	I took (them). You, as my representative,
	<i>ù Puzur₄ UTU DUMU Šu-°Nu-nu₂</i>	and Puzur-Šamaš, son of Šu-Nunu,
	<i>[š^{ri}]*-sí-a : [l]á-lik-ma</i>	must <i>settle accounts</i> , then I will go
l.e	<i>[me-e]°h-ri-a ù₂* ta-[ah-s]í-sà-ti-a</i>	[to inspect] my copies and memos
15	<i>[lá-mur-ma x x]-nim-ma</i>	
rev.	<i>[x x x x x x] x*</i>	
	<i>[x x x x]-lá DUMU Šu-Nu-nu</i>	la, the son of Šu-Nunu
	<i>[na-áš-a₂-kum : a-sé-er</i>	[is bringing?] to you. To your
	<i>[x ma-n]a* 1⅓ GÍN KÙ.B.-pì-kà 1 ma-na</i>	[x mina] 1⅓ shekel of silver
20	<i>°ú-ŕ]a-da-ma : ú-šé-ba-lá-ku-ma</i>	[I will ad]d 1 mina and send it to you and
	<i>ù i-na e-lá-i-kà : lu ni-iz-ku</i>	when you come here, we must clear
	<i>a-na a-wa-tim : a-ni-a-tim</i>	accounts. For these words
	<i>kà-ru-um Kà-ni-iš^{ki}</i>	the Kanesh colony made me available
	<i>i-dí-ni-ma IGI GÍR ša A-šùr</i>	and before the dagger of Aššur
25	<i>ší-bu-tí : a-dí-in IGI Bu-°za-zu₂</i>	I gave my testimony. In the presence of
	<i>DUMU Pu-šu-ki-in</i>	Buzāzu, son of Pūšu-kēn;
	<i>Li-ip-tí-lštar DUMU lš-ma-A-[š]ur</i>	Lipit-lštar, son of lšme-Aššur
	<i>tap-pá-i</i>	was my companion.

Notes

7. I consider Pilahānum (notwithstanding *UAR* 6a, top, "Fürchte Anum!"), a variant of Pilah-Aššur, since a man of that name, also the son of Dānum-ilī, occurs in BIN 4, 160:29, during month VI of eponymy year REL 108, and in *197:15-16, as witness in a debt-note recording a claim of Ir'am-Aššur, during month VIII of eponymy year REL 92. As absent witness he is also mentioned in the undated record Kt a/k 403:23-24 // Kt a/k 513:19.

9. Kaskanu'il may be a phonetic variant of Kashanu'il / Kishanu'il.

24-25. The man who validates this deposition and must have sealed the envelope containing it, is one of the two ("us") men seized by the conflicting parties as witnesses or arbitrators according to I. 2. When the case in due time came before the colony only Buzāzu was available to testify, but the record also mentions his fellow witness; see Veenhof 1991, 453ff.

Comment

I assume that Puzur-Aššur had taken some debt-notes of Ir'am-Aššur to satisfy himself for a claim on him or to force the latter to settle accounts, hence the verb in line 13, which links up with the promise made in I. 20.

204. Kt 91/k 512 (1-365-91)

The record of a confrontation during eponymy year REL 109, validated by two witnesses, between Ir'am-Aššur and three men about a claim on him by Šuli, son of Buzutaya, who had given him (via another trader) silver for making purchases (presumably in Assur). One of them is the son of the just-mentioned Šuli, who acknowledges to have been paid (lines 14-15), which the three men confirm. They add that "on the basis of what your record states the *tamkārum* will sue you for his silver".

	<i>Ir-ma-A-šur a-na DÙG-°ší-li-/A-šur</i>	Ir'am-Aššur seized us against
	<i>DUMU Ì-lí-a-lúm</i>	Ṭāb-šilli-Aššur, son of Ilī-ālum,
	<i>°Lá-qé-pí-im DUMU Puzur₄-A-na</i>	La-qēpum, son of Puzur-Anna,
	<i>°ù₂ I-šu-hi-im DUMU Šu-lí</i>	and Išuhum, son of Šuli,
5	<i>ša ki-ma Šu-lí iṣ-ba-at-ni-a-/tí-ma</i>	representing Šuli, and
	<i>um-ma Ir-ma-°A-šur₂-ma</i>	Ir'am-Aššur said: "2 ½ minas
	<i>2 ½ ma-na KÙ.B. °ša₂ Šu-lí</i>	of silver belonging to Šuli, son of
	<i>DUMU Bu-zu-t[a-a] <ša> E]n-na-Sú-°in₂</i>	Buzutaya, which Ennam-Suen, son
of		
	<i>DUMU Ì-lí-a a-na ší-a-ma-°tim₂</i>	līya, gave me for making purchases
10	<i>i-dí-na-ni-ma qá-tí ú-kà-i-lu-/ma</i>	and which I kept in my possession and
	<i>a-wa-tí-a °Ah₂-ša-lim DUMU Bu-zu-ta-a</i>	for which Ah-šalim, son of
Buzutāya,		
	<i>Bé-lá-num °DUMU₂ Šu-A-šur ù</i>	Bēlānum, son of Šu-Aššur, and
	<i>A-šur-°tak₂-lá-ku DUMU A-lá₂hi₂-im</i>	Aššur-taklāku, son of Ali-ahum
i.e.	<i>ig-mu-ru-ni KÙ.B. šu-a-tí</i>	settled my case, with that silver you ^{sing} .
15	<i>ki-ma Šu-lí ša-bu-a-tí</i>	have been satisfied as representative of
Šuli.		
rev.	<i>Šu-lí DUMU Bu-zu-ta-a</i>	Šuli, son of Buzutāya, shall not raise
	<i>lá i-tù-ra-am um-ma DÙG-ší-li-/A-šur/-a</i>	claim (for it) against me'. Ṭāb-šilli-Aššur,
	<i>Lá-qé-ep DUMU Puzur₂-A-na [ma</i>	La-qēp, son of Puzur-Anna, and

- 20 *ù l-šu-hu-um* DUMU Šu-lí
a-na Ir-ma-A-šur-ma KÙ.B.
ša Šu-lí ša a-wa-at-kà
gám-ra-a-ni Šu-lí ša-bu-a-ni
a-na ša ʔup-pí-kà
a-na KÙ.B. DAM.GÀR-ru-um
25 *i-šé-e-kà i-na ha-muš-/tim*
ša A-šur-iš-ti-kál DUMU Sú-kà--a
u.e. ITU.KAM *tí-i-na-tim*
li-mu-um
le.e. *Ma-ší-i-[lí] IGI Ku-da-dim*
30 DUMU A-šur-[DÙG] IGI DINGIR?
DUMU °A-šur-na-da [na-da
- lšuhum, son of Šuli, answered
Ir'am-Aššur: "With the silver of Šuli,
whose affair with you has been settled,
we have satisfied Šuli.
On the basis of what your record states
the *tamkārum* will sue you
for the silver". During the week of
Aššuriš-tikal, son of Sukalliya,
month X of the eponymy of
Maši-ilī .
In the presence of Kudādum,
son of Aššur-[tāb], of Ilī-nādā,
son of Aššur-nādā.

Notes

5. That Šuli is represented by his son and that in l. 11 his brother Ah-šalim played a role in settling the issue of his silver suggests that Šuli himself was dead.

8. The line is damaged, but we need a *ša* to explain the subjunctive *iddinanni* in l. 10.

12. See for this man, active in various capacities, as week-eponym, attorney and mediator, *OALP* 346, note 1105.

15. The stative *šabbu'āti* is passive and must be addressed to Šuli's son, but the plural *šabbu'āni* of line 22 (of which the three men of lines 17-19 are the subject; the final *-ma* of l. 17 comes too early) must be active, preceded by its personal object, Šuli. The payment probably was effectuated via the three men mentioned in lines 17-19.

21-22. One expects *awatka gamratni* or *awātuka gamrāni*.

26. The correction of the name of the father is based on CCT 4, 21b:6, 5, 43:11, etc. Our Aššuriš-tikal is attested as week eponym in eponymy year REL 106 (TPAK I, 87:5' and Kt 91/k 204:8).

30. The restoration of the first name is suggested by the room available and by TC 3, 29:27, Kudādum, father of Aššur-ṭāb. See for the second person ICK 2, 128 rev.:33', TC 3, 213:31, and VS 26, 121:6.

Comment

It is not easy to understand this record. Ir'am-Aššur apparently had received silver of Šuli, via Ennam-Suen (l. 8), for a commercial purpose, which obviously should be paid back in some way to its owner. He may have been approached by the three men mentioned in lines 1-4, among whom a son of Šuli, or he has summoned them and in front of witnesses told them that his case already had been settled by three other men, including a brother of Šuli, so that Šuli's son (and heir) is satisfied (l. 15) and Šuli himself cannot claim anything from him. The payment apparently had been indirect, perhaps in the framework of a larger settlement of accounts, which may have taken place if indeed Šuli was not longer alive (as suggested in the comment on line 5). The three men summoned acknowledge this by the rather puzzling statement "we have satisfied Šuli with the silver". Our understanding is also hampered by their following remark, that they leave it to the/a *tamkārum* to sue Ir'am-Aššur for the silver he still owes on the basis of tablet. This may also point to a more general settlement of accounts that could result in new debt-notes, at times also ones that left the creditor anonymous (calling him *tamkārum*), e.g. because it was not yet clear who was entitled to the money (e.g. when a firm was liquidated). But there may be other explanations,

since *tamkārum* could also mean the manager of a joint-stock capital or the boss of a firm.

A memo

205. Kt 91/k 335 (1-192-91)

A small, oblong tablet, only the obverse of which is inscribed, mentioning a financial claim on Ir'am-Aššur. Its presence in Elamma's archive suggests that he (or a son of his) was the unnamed creditor.

18 ¼ GÍN
KÙ.B. *i-li-bi*₄
Ir-ma-A-šùr

18 ¼ shekels of
silver due from
Ir'am-Aššur.